

art class questions

ahaan shokeen

2026-04-21

1 strand $\emptyset$

1. the 1960s were a time of great global transformation. the cold war created tensions between the united states of america and the union of soviet socialist republics. artists realized that normal, traditional art could not accurately represent these times of turmoil. they decided that art was not about what it looked like, but about the meaning. they asked the question: *what does this mean?* and questioned things like who decided the definition of art.
2. because the focus of the art was now the idea and meaning, the technical skill behind making the artwork did not matter as much. now, artists did not simply make a nice picture, they expressed their thoughts, emotions, and ideas through subtext or an implied meaning. people were now expected to analyse, question and think about the art they saw, rather than just look at it and admire the technical skills.
3. in conceptualism, changing the context has a massive effect. because conceptual art is *heavily symbolic*, the way it is represented changes the artwork entirely. for example, the artwork *one and three chairs* by joseph kosuth shows how the same word, *chair*, can be interpreted differently as a picture of a chair, a real chair, or the definition of a chair.
4. the relationship changed because now, viewers were expected to reinterpret, to analyse, to inquire, to think and really melt away the solid fluff to reveal the true meaning behind the artwork. this made things more interactive and allowed people to have differing opinions on the same artwork.
5. in my personal opinion, conceptual art is a lot *nicer* than traditional art because of the way it relies on interpretation. i am free to interpret it however i want, allowing me to express my identity better. this is not something you can do with traditional art, which is why it limits our expression and therefore our identity, the opposite of what conceptualism does.

2 strand $\{\emptyset\}$

1. i first see the red balloon, and this is probably because the rest of the picture is a clean, nice, minimalist greyscale theme, and the red balloon sticks out like a pointy thorn.
2. i see a person, likely a young person. using the title of the artwork, i can determine that the person in question is a young girl. there is a red balloon shaped in an ugly and unrealistic shape floating away.
3. the coloured balloon sticks out against the dramatic and epic greyscale background, to show the importance of the balloon. the jagged shading depicts a sharp light source.
4. the balloon is the only bright colour because it appears to be the central idea of the painting. it is designed to draw the attention of an observer, although depending upon the velocity of the picture or observer, the balloon may not be red.
5. the balloon represents childhood and immaturity. she is letting go of her immaturity as she realizes she can be a great physicist, disregarding wasted childhood and using it for something worthwhile.
6. she is letting go. her stance is solemn but knowing, as she sends it off to symbolize her sad but necessary decision. it is symbolic of reality.
7. the street wall creates a sense of personality and familiarity, as a museum could discourage creative interpretations and discussions, whilst a street wall is also more accessible.
8. the artist is trying to show that we must leave our childhood behind eventually, whether we like it or not. amazing for some, sad for others, this is not possible. no, it is necessary.
9. unlike us, who are studying it in a classroom, someone who walks by on the street would see it in the light of, say, hope, due to the *blatantly obvious* message on the staircase. i know, i am a genius.